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The Editorial Office
RAS Techniques and Instruments

Dear Editor,

We submit our manuscript, “A morphological barrier: quantifying the injection realism gap for CNN strong lens finders in DESI Legacy Survey DR10,” for consideration as a Research article in RAS Techniques and Instruments.

This manuscript was originally submitted to MNRAS (MN-26-1590-P). The MNRAS Editorial Board judged it a methods contribution that falls outside the scope of MNRAS and recommended transfer to RASTI, which we have accepted. As a study of machine-learning methods, data-analysis techniques, and openly released software for calibrating convolutional neural network lens finders, we believe it falls squarely within RASTI’s scope.

The injection-recovery pipeline, the selection-function grid results, and the analysis code accompanying this paper are publicly available in a GitHub repository to support reuse by the community; details are given in the Data Availability statement.

This manuscript has not been published previously and is not under consideration by any other journal. All authors have read the final version and approved its submission.

AI tool disclosure. In accordance with RASTI policy, we disclose that AI language models (Claude, Anthropic; ChatGPT, OpenAI) were used as coding assistants during the development of analysis scripts and for manuscript copy-editing. All AI-assisted code was reviewed, tested, and verified by the authors, who are solely responsible for the scientific content of this paper.

We have no preferred or non-preferred reviewers.

Authors declare no conflict of interest.

Yours sincerely,

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